

Throwbacks and pullbacks. Throwbacks and pullbacks occur about two-thirds of the time, and it takes between 12 and 13 days, on average, for the stock to return to the breakout price.

When a throwback or pullback occurs, performance suffers. That's typical. Look for nearby support or resistance to reduce the chance of a throwback or pullback.

If a throwback or pullback occurs, price resumes the breakout direction most often (but downward breakouts show the direction is almost random).

Gaps. Gaps help performance except in bear markets, and even in bull markets after a downward breakout, the performance difference isn't an event worth standing on your desk and shouting, "Oh, Captain, my Captain!" Don't get that reference? Watch the movie, *Dead Poets Society*.

[Table 59.5](#) shows pattern size statistics.

Height. Tall patterns perform better than short ones except in bull markets after upward breakouts.

To use this finding, measure the height of the pattern from the top to the bottom of the scallop and divide by the breakout price. If the result is greater than the median shown in the table, then you have a tall pattern.

Width. Scallop width doesn't give a performance edge worth trying to figure out how wide the pattern is.

Height and width combinations. Tall and narrow patterns show better performance in two of three columns. The opposite of that, short and wide, do best after upward breakouts in bull markets.

[Table 59.6](#) shows volume-related statistics.

Volume trend. I used linear regression to determine the volume trend from the start to the end of the scallop.

Rising/Falling, heavy/light breakout day volume. Only upward breakouts in bull markets show much of a performance difference compared to the other two columns. Patterns with rising volume and heavy breakout volume do best under those conditions.

[Table 59.7](#) shows how often price reaches a stop location. I removed upward breakouts because the results are inaccurate.